

IELTS Writing: Time Panic 40+20

Book 21 · Finish Task 1 and Task 2 without clock disaster

Stratum IELTS · stratumielts.com

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Pain this book solves

You spend 35 minutes on Task 1...

Then rush Task 2 and kill your overall Writing score.

Remember: **Task 2 carries more weight**. Protect its time.

Default timing (60 minutes total)

Task	Time	Words
Task 1	20 min	150+
Task 2	40 min	250+

Task 1 split

3 plan · 14 write · 3 check

Task 2 split

5 plan · 30 write · 5 check

Panic protocols

If Task 1 is running long at minute 18

Stop adding tiny numbers. Write a short conclusion sentence if needed and **switch to Task 2**.

If Task 2 has no idea at minute 6

Force Book 7 lenses: pick any 2 relevant angles and start Body 1.

If you finish Task 2 with 2 minutes left

Hunt only: task coverage, articles, agreement — not style rewrites.

Training drills

1. **Alarm drill:** Task 1 with hard stop at 20:00
2. **Switch drill:** practise stopping mid-Task-1 detail to start Task 2 (builds discipline)
3. **Weekly mock:** full 60 minutes once a week

Track times in a notebook. Check quality at <https://stratumielts.com>.

Exam card

Start with the task you usually overcook — but still cap Task 1 at 20.
Most candidates should do Task 1 first *only if* they can truly stop at 20.

End of Book 21 · stratumielts.com